

SCAFFOLD

SUPPORTS TERTIARY WHAT

FOR WHY-HOW · HOW-WHY

The Closing Card

An end-of-meeting forcing function: one action, one owner, one date, written before anyone leaves. **No conversation ends without becoming movement.**

THE DRAIN

Rich discussion is energizing for WHY-HOW and HOW-WHY profiles; converting it into commitments is not. Meetings end with deep shared understanding and no owner, and the understanding quietly expires. The pattern reads to others as inaction, whatever the quality of the thinking.

WHAT THIS TOOL DOES

The card is a sixty-second ritual at the end of any working conversation. It demands exactly four lines, which is deliberately minimal: the smallest possible unit of momentum. Filled in and sent while everyone is present, it converts insight into a commitment nobody has to remember.

The card

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|-----------------------|--|
| 1 One action | The single next physical step. Not a theme, a step. |
| 2 One owner | A name. "The team" is not a name. |
| 3 One date | When it will be done, said out loud. |
| 4 One line of context | Why this step, so the card survives out of the room. |

HOW TO USE IT

- 1 **Claim the last two minutes.** Announce it at the start: "we'll close with the card." The ritual needs protected time.
- 2 **Write it in the room.** Not after. The card filled in later is a card filled in never.
- 3 **Send it to everyone present.** One message, four lines. It is the record and the reminder.
- 4 **Open the next meeting with it.** Card review is the first agenda item. Closed loops build the momentum habit.

WHAT IT WON'T DO

One action per meeting is a floor, not a ceiling; complex sessions need real planning beyond the card. And the card cannot supply follow-through by itself, it makes the commitment visible, which is the condition for follow-through, not the guarantee.

IN THE KIT

Printable card pads

Digital card template

Meeting-open review script

PAIRS WELL WITH

Tool 18 Progress Broadcast Template · **Tool 13** Decision Deadline Ritual · **Tool 41** Meeting Keeper Cards